Power BI
INTERVIEWER-STYLE PRACTICE

Fresher Data Analyst | English answers + Hindi explanations + practical examples + follow-up cross questions

20 interview scenarios | Practice answering aloud | Use only project details you have actually verified

How to practice

Read the question first and answer aloud before reading the model answer. Learn the concept, not just the wording. For syntax, mention that exact functions may vary by tool or database version. For project questions, describe only work you personally completed.

Interviewer Q1: Explain your end-to-end Power BI workflow.

Suggested English answer: I connect to source data, clean it in Power Query, build a model and relationships, create DAX measures, design visuals, validate results, and publish with refresh settings.

Hindi me samjho: Data connect → Power Query cleaning → model/relationships → DAX → visuals → validation → publish/refresh.

Interviewer follow-up: Why separate cleaning and modeling?

How to answer: It makes transformations repeatable and the model easier to understand and maintain.

Interviewer Q2: What is the difference between a measure and a calculated column?

Suggested English answer: A measure is evaluated at query time under filter context; a calculated column is computed row by row and stored in the model.

Hindi me samjho: Measure slicer/filter ke hisab se calculate; calculated column row-wise store hota hai.

```
Practical example:
Total Sales = SUM(Sales[Amount])
```

Interviewer follow-up: When would you use a calculated column?

How to answer: For row-level attributes needed for relationships, grouping, or categories; prefer measures for aggregations.

Interviewer Q3: Explain filter context with an example.

Suggested English answer: Filter context is the filters affecting a measure, such as a Year slicer or a product category selected in a chart.

Hindi me samjho: Slicer ya visual selection measure ke result ko filter karta hai.

```
Practical example:
Sales West = CALCULATE([Total Sales], Region[Region]="West")
```

Interviewer follow-up: What does CALCULATE do?

How to answer: It evaluates an expression after modifying filter context.

Interviewer Q4: What is row context?

Suggested English answer: Row context evaluates an expression for the current row, such as a calculated column or iterator like SUMX.

Hindi me samjho: Current row ke basis par expression evaluate hona row context hai.

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Practical example:
Line Amount = Sales[Quantity] * Sales[UnitPrice]
```

Interviewer follow-up: Does row context automatically filter related tables?

How to answer: Not by itself; context transition and relationship behavior matter. CALCULATE can perform context transition.

Interviewer Q5: Why use a star schema?

Suggested English answer: A fact table stores events or measurements and dimension tables provide descriptive attributes. This often improves clarity and filtering behavior.

Hindi me samjho: Fact me transactions/KPIs; dimensions me date, product, outlet jaise descriptions.

Interviewer follow-up: What can go wrong with a flat table?

How to answer: Repeated attributes increase model size and can complicate relationships and maintenance.

Interviewer Q6: How do you create a previous-year sales measure?

Suggested English answer: With a continuous date table related to the fact table, I use CALCULATE with SAMEPERIODLASTYEAR.

Hindi me samjho: Proper Date table aur relationship ke saath pichhle saal ki matching date range ka sales nikaalte hain.

```
Practical example:
Sales LY = CALCULATE([Total Sales], SAMEPERIODLASTYEAR('Date'[Date]))
```

Interviewer follow-up: What if the result is blank?

How to answer: Check date table continuity, relationship, date range, data availability, and whether the date table is marked appropriately.

Interviewer Q7: How do you calculate YoY percentage?

Suggested English answer: I divide the difference between current and prior-year sales by prior-year sales using DIVIDE to handle zero denominators.

Hindi me samjho: Current minus last year, phir last year se divide; DIVIDE zero denominator safely handle karta hai.

```
Practical example:
YoY % = DIVIDE([Total Sales]-[Sales LY],[Sales LY])
```

Interviewer follow-up: Why use DIVIDE instead of /?

How to answer: DIVIDE supports an alternate result for zero or blank denominator.

Interviewer Q8: What is Power Query used for?

Suggested English answer: It performs repeatable extract, transform, and load steps such as changing types, removing duplicates, splitting columns, and combining files.

Hindi me samjho: Data load se pehle cleaning/transform steps repeatable banata hai.

Interviewer follow-up: Does Power Query replace DAX?

How to answer: No. Power Query transforms data at refresh; DAX calculates model measures and expressions.

Interviewer Q9: What is query folding?

Suggested English answer: Query folding pushes supported transformations back to the source system, which can improve refresh efficiency.

Hindi me samjho: Supported transformations source database ko push ho jaate hain, jisse refresh efficient ho sakta hai.

Interviewer follow-up: How can you check it?

How to answer: In Power Query, inspect the step's View Native Query option where supported.

Interviewer Q10: Explain one-to-many relationship.

Suggested English answer: One unique dimension key can relate to many fact rows, such as one product appearing in many sales transactions.

Hindi me samjho: Dimension ka unique ProductID fact table ki multiple sales rows se link hota hai.

Interviewer follow-up: Which direction should filters flow?

How to answer: Usually dimension to fact in a star schema; choose direction intentionally and avoid ambiguous paths.

Interviewer Q11: What is a slicer and how would a manager use it?

Suggested English answer: A slicer is an interactive filter. A manager could select outlet type or region and compare the same KPIs across segments.

Hindi me samjho: Manager outlet/region select karke same KPI compare kar sakta hai.

Interviewer follow-up: What if slicer doesn't affect a visual?

How to answer: Check Edit interactions, relationships, visual-level filters, and whether the fields are connected in the model.

Interviewer Q12: How do you choose visuals?

Suggested English answer: Cards for headline metrics, bars for category comparisons, lines for time trends, and tables for detailed records.

Hindi me samjho: KPI card, comparison bar, time trend line, detailed data table.

Interviewer follow-up: Why avoid too many visuals?

How to answer: Clutter slows interpretation and can affect report performance.

Interviewer Q13: How would you explain your Blinkit dashboard?

Suggested English answer: It is a business report intended to monitor sales and item/outlet performance through headline KPIs, category comparisons, and filters. I would explain only insights verified from my actual report.

Hindi me samjho: Blinkit dashboard sales, item aur outlet performance monitor karta hai. Sirf actual report se verify ki hui insight explain karunga.

Interviewer follow-up: Which KPIs did you include?

How to answer: Typical KPIs include Total Sales, Average Sales, Item Count, and Average Rating; confirm exact measure definitions from the project.

Interviewer Q14: How do you validate a Power BI dashboard?

Suggested English answer: I reconcile totals with source or SQL, test slicers and relationships, inspect blanks, and manually verify selected records and measures.

Hindi me samjho: Source/SQL total match, slicer test, blanks aur sample records check.

Interviewer follow-up: What if a total is double-counted?

How to answer: Inspect relationship cardinality, duplicate keys, join expansion, and measure logic.

Interviewer Q15: What is Import versus DirectQuery?

Suggested English answer: Import stores data in the model for in-memory analysis; DirectQuery sends queries to the source, trading off freshness, source load, and performance.

Hindi me samjho: Import model me data load karta hai; DirectQuery source par query karta hai. Dono ke performance/freshness trade-offs hain.

Interviewer follow-up: Can DirectQuery always be faster?

How to answer: No. It depends on source performance, model design, query complexity, and concurrency.

Interviewer Q16: What is row-level security?

Suggested English answer: RLS limits which rows users can see based on roles and identity, and must be tested with the intended users.

Hindi me samjho: User/role ke basis par data rows restrict karta hai.

Interviewer follow-up: Does hiding a page secure data?

How to answer: No. Use appropriate model security such as RLS; hiding visuals is not data security.

Interviewer Q17: How do you improve report performance?

Suggested English answer: Use a clean star schema, remove unused columns, reduce high-cardinality fields where possible, simplify visuals, and inspect Performance Analyzer.

Hindi me samjho: Model clean rakho, unused columns hatao, visuals simplify karo aur Performance Analyzer dekho.

Interviewer follow-up: What is cardinality in this context?

How to answer: It refers to the number of distinct values; high-cardinality columns can increase model memory.

Interviewer Q18: What is a dashboard versus a report?

Suggested English answer: A report can have multiple interactive pages. A Power BI Service dashboard is a single-page canvas of pinned tiles.

Hindi me samjho: Report multi-page interactive; Service dashboard single-page tiles.

Interviewer follow-up: Where do you publish?

How to answer: Publish from Desktop to a workspace, then configure permissions, credentials, and refresh.

Interviewer Q19: How do you handle a many-to-many relationship?

Suggested English answer: I examine the data grain and may use a bridge table with unique keys to make filter paths explicit.

Hindi me samjho: Data grain samajhkar bridge table use kar sakte hain; ambiguous paths avoid karte hain.

Interviewer follow-up: Why can many-to-many be risky?

How to answer: It can create ambiguous filter behavior or unexpected totals if the model is not designed carefully.

Interviewer Q20: What would you say if asked about a project challenge?

Suggested English answer: I would describe a real challenge I faced, the steps I took, and how I verified the fix. I would not claim a challenge I did not encounter.

Hindi me samjho: Apna actual challenge, solution aur validation batao; fabricated experience nahi.

Interviewer follow-up: Give an example structure.

How to answer: Situation → issue → action → validation → learning.

Final interview reminder: Pause, clarify the requirement, explain your approach, and validate the result. It is acceptable to say you would verify a detail rather than guess.